

Agreement Lab

Six rounds · two moves · one reason · Printable participant cards

How to Play

Agreement Lab is a six-round negotiation discussion game. Work in mixed teams of 3-5. Read a situation, select exactly two of the three move cards, and agree one sentence explaining your choice. The dashboard reveals feedback and awards one learning point per supported move (maximum 12). These are learning prompts, not a measurement of bargaining competence. An optional 90-second timer can prompt discussion; it does not lock the round.

Use one round as a 10-15-minute energizer during the suggested day, or all six as a 45-60-minute review. After feedback, discuss what evidence or authority would change your answer. Export the team reflection at the end. No confidential simulation information is used.

Round 1 - Ask before dividing

A staff rota dispute is presented as a demand for more reserved spaces. Both teams are ready to argue a number. You have five minutes to open the conversation.

Move card	Action
Ask what matters	Paraphrase the demand, then ask what problem the requested number would solve.
Explore different priorities	Ask which times, uses or conditions matter most to each side.
Split the number immediately	Offer half before asking about the problem.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____

Round 2 - Agree the measure

The teams cite two different wage-bill percentages. Each says its number proves the other side is wrong.

Move card	Action
Define the denominator	Agree the institutions, revenue basis, time period and wage components.
Check the source	Ask for the publication, date and assumptions behind each figure.
Average the percentages	Use the midpoint without investigating the definitions.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____

Round 3 - Find the authority

One mandate permits monthly review. The other permits quarterly review only. The negotiators currently have no authority to change those limits.

Move card	Action
Clarify the limits	State the conflict in mandates and identify who can authorize a change.
Seek a revised mandate	Propose a caucus or a dated referral to the principals with a specific option.
Sign a convenient compromise	Promise a different interval without consulting either principal.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____

Round 4 · Protect a safe voice

Staff raise a biological-exposure concern in a hospital or teaching laboratory. A manager suggests dropping the reporting issue in exchange for an allowance.

Move card	Action
Protect reporting	Agree a safe reporting route and action on the hazard through the responsible process.
Involve the right people	Include appropriate worker representation and those responsible for prevention and implementation.
Trade silence for payment	Accept the allowance if staff stop raising the safety concern.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____

Round 5 · Lower the temperature

A delegate calls the other team dishonest. The conversation is becoming personal and both sides are interrupting.

Move card	Action
Acknowledge and check	Recognize the concern, paraphrase the disputed point and ask for the evidence.
Take a purposeful pause	Call a short break and agree what each side will clarify before returning.
Match the volume	Interrupt more loudly so your side is not seen as weak.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____

Round 6 · Make it implementable

The room is relieved: the teams seem to have agreement. There are ten minutes left and the funding and review dates are still vague.

Move card	Action
Read back the specifics	Confirm what, who, amount, date, unresolved issues and the written record.
Check implementation authority	Confirm lawful funding, necessary approvals, registration where required and a review point.
Close with a handshake	Leave the details for later because the atmosphere is good.

Choose two. Our reason: _____

What would we ask or check in a real negotiation? _____